

In some cases, such as PHP itself, it might suggest you to run either ‘make test’ or ‘make check’. This action would actually run an automatic test trying to determine whether everything was compiled as expected or were there some errors. Do so before running ‘sudo make install’. In case you find some tests failing, you should use the best of your judgment powers to determine whether or not the software should be installed.

Your software should be installed after ‘sudo make install’. But wait, do not delete the php-5.3.6 directory. If later on, you want to remove PHP from the machine, you can go back in to the same directory and run ‘sudo make uninstall’ and the software would get removed from your system in an easy way. Otherwise, removing files individually is a real tough challenge, and one with no benefits in almost all cases.

While all this might seem quite easy, the most difficult part of installing software by compilation is where you have to resolve dependencies. It is this part which makes the task challenging and geeky. Keeping that part aside, there is almost nothing to be afraid of when it comes to installing software by compilation.

Using Synaptic for offline package installation

We have already shown you how to install software on Ubuntu without an Internet connection by compiling software on it. However we believe we have also demonstrated that resolving dependencies and installing them before the software in need is a task challenging enough to make those tremble who use pacemakers to keep their heart running. It was this reason that package management was invented. Package managers like YUM and APT were created to keep track of what was installed and when; which software depends on what and where to find one if a package is needed. Package managers were created to be able to install pre-compiled software packaged on computers and keep track of them. Since installing software by source also takes a lot of time depending on the machine configuration and the amount of code, package management came up as a better solution. It was because of such inventions that Ubuntu enjoys the ‘search-click-go’ style for software installation.

However, this style involves heavy use of Internet, which for some is still a luxury, leave alone the matters of unlimited downloads and high speeds. If you think that it is going to be very tough, you are mistaken. It is going to be a little different but not too tough. Well, to begin with, ask yourself – how does someone install a software on Windows if he does not have it? In